Investigation report

Is an unusually large source payment real?

Does the unusually large source payment represent a real charge?

Data

Authorized synthetic PocketToons SQLite
All available records, April-September 2026 UTC

Snapshot

Metadata as-of 2026-09-30 23:59:59 UTC
Build 3a0dbed21d2f45958aefa2887a0cadd8

Run

Independent
2026-11-09
16 read-only SQL checks

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How to read this report

- Checks refer to numbered evidence JSONL files. Amounts are USD.
- Bronze preserves source; Silver records validated payment attempts; Gold summarizes monthly metrics.

Terms used in this report

Term	Meaning
Source amount	Provider-supplied value, which may use misleading units.
Revenue	Revenue group v1.1: charge at its single success event, less successful refunds.

01. Chapter

The answer

01

The apparent $999 payment is not supported as a $999 charge. Seven source records show 999.0 labelled USD; review identifies each as 999 cents, and the curated charge is $9.99. Each has one recorded success (checks 7, 10).

- These are seven distinct $9.99 successful subscription charges, $69.93 gross; one was refunded $9.99, leaving $59.94 net across the linked transactions (checks 10, 12, 13).
- Treating each raw 999.0 as dollars would overstate these gross charges by $990.01 each, or $6,923.07 in total. This is a hypothetical raw-ingestion error, not an observed error in Gold.
- The review states the provider sent cents, but the provider evidence itself is not available here; review completion times are unknown.

02. Chapter

How we investigated

02

What data we used

- Independent investigation of all 6,544 payment records; UTC source arrivals from 2026-04-01 through 2026-09-25 (checks 6, 8). No single transaction was specified; all seven identical outliers were examined.
- Dataset metadata records user, catalog and entitlement snapshots at 2026-09-30T23:59:59Z. These are declared timestamps, not a verified database hash or a transaction freshness guarantee (check 2).
- Build succeeded 2026-11-09 11:16:56 UTC with all recorded reconciliation checks passing; 20 Bronze views, 10 Silver and 8 Gold tables exist (checks 1, 3).
- Build registry SHA-256 starts 57b21d71; current registry SHA-256 starts 4b5b2f0e. Builder SHA matches 12fd6588. Definition label revenue_group 1.1 matches, but registry contents and post-build source freshness were not independently reconciled.

Investigation path

- Baseline: profile all source representations and compare to curated subscription amounts (checks 6, 11, 14).
- H1: a unit error explains the outliers - supported by seven review records and matched prices, conditional on review reliability (check 10).
- H2: $999 is the actual charge - contradicted by reviewed and curated amounts; external settlement was not independently available (check 10).
- H3: the payment never succeeded - rejected for these seven based on one success event each; a later refund is separate (checks 10, 13).

03. Chapter

What happened

03

The movement

- Source distribution: 5,382 numeric and 899 text values of 9.99; 215 numeric and 35 text values of 1.99; seven text values of 999.0; six unavailable text values. Values include charges and refunds, not just successful charges (check 14).
- All 6,288 curated subscription attempts have amount $9.99: 4,777 renewals and 1,511 initial purchases, including any failed attempts (check 11).

Who drove it

- Seven outliers: six initial subscriptions and one renewal, each reviewed from 999.0 USD to $9.99. Their individual transaction IDs and event dates are in check 10.
- Seven charges contribute $69.93 gross; a single $9.99 linked successful refund reduces the combined net to $59.94. No other linked refund attempts appear (checks 12-13).

04. Chapter
Why it happened
04

- Review reason says provider sent cents and the value was reconciled to purchase price. Each curated original amount and list price is $9.99; Silver recognizes 999 cents per success. This supports a scaling error rather than an unusually large charge, but those fields are not independent settlement verification (check 10).
- If raw 999.0 were wrongly read as dollars for all seven charges, the gross total would be $6,993.00 rather than $69.93, overstated $6,923.07. Refunds and other records are held constant in this illustrative gross-only calculation.

05. Chapter
Data quality and limits
05

Data quality

- All 6,544 source records have matching transactions; 6,544 Silver attempts have unique IDs. The source key prevents duplicate non-null IDs (checks 5, 8, 16).
- There are 13 reviewed corrections: seven scaling errors and six unavailable raw amounts. Silver quality exceptions expose all 13 (checks 9, 12).
- Review timestamps are NULL, so availability of corrections at any historical point cannot be established. Build fingerprints document sources at build time; current source content was not independently hashed.

Limitations

- The fixture is synthetic. Neither actual provider settlement records nor independent external payment evidence were inspected. Review rationale is a recorded assertion.
- The database has no transaction snapshot timestamp. Snapshot labels and source fingerprints do not prove present freshness. Registry file mismatch limits confidence in interpreting Gold with current documentation.

06. Chapter
What to do next
06

- Use the reviewed $9.99 amounts and success-time revenue rules for current analysis; preserve raw values and exception flags.
- For operational verification, retrieve provider settlement evidence and timestamps, verify the seven source-unit mappings, and add a unit consistency alert.
- Reconcile current source fingerprints and the changed registry against the build before relying on Gold as current; do not rebuild the authorized database without permission.

Appendix

Evidence appendix

A

- Evidence files query-01.jsonl through query-16.jsonl contain bounded read-only SQL, results, durations and truncation flags. Matching request JSON files provide context.
- 01 layer inventory; 02 metadata; 03 build and reconciliation; 04 numeric-only profile; 05 schemas; 06 storage and units; 07 text and reviews; 08 coverage; 09 exceptions; 10 seven traces; 11 subscription baseline; 12 reviewed contributions; 13 linked refunds; 14 raw distribution; 15 Gold revenue; 16 Silver coverage.
- Repository directory has no Git metadata; commit and download date unavailable. AGENTS.md observed modification 2026-11-09 20:12:48 IST, which is a file timestamp, not a download date. Full hashes and run timing are recorded in run-notes.txt.